Annual Field Notes

This report summarises the **observations of the 2026 season**. Some terms are *emphasised*, a few are ***both bold and italic***, and one is underlined for no good reason. A ~~struck-out~~ figure was corrected.

Weather

The season opened cold and clear, turned unusually warm in July and ended in steady rain. Peak water temperature reached 19.4 °C, about 2.1 °C above the long-term mean.

Measurements

Readings used the formula $T_{adj} = T_{raw} - 0.12 \cdot h$, where h is the depth in metres; salinity is in g/kg (10^{-3}). Larger text and smaller text appear in the same paragraph.

> *“The sea was the colour of slate and just as still,” wrote the observer on 3 September.*

Birds

In the winter of 1893 the ice reached the outer skerries, something no one in the village had seen before. The keeper walked across to the nearest island with his son, measured the ice with an auger and wrote that it was thicker than the kitchen table and twice as level.

Visitors were rare and were recorded with care: a priest in 1880, a painter who stayed for three weeks in 1911 and left a small oil sketch of the tower, and a group of surveyors whose instruments, the log notes drily, were less reliable than the keeper's barometer.

Notable sightings

White-tailed eagle: two adults, regularly. **Puffin:** a single bird on 14 June. *Arctic tern* colonies returned to the outer skerries.

Next steps

Today the tower belongs to a foundation that opens it to the public in summer. The log books have been scanned, transcribed and indexed, and a small exhibition in the old oil store shows the lamp, the auger and a page from the winter of 1893.